

Introduction to Prompt Techniques

Prompt techniques are smart ways to guide how an AI thinks or responds, helping users shape the output in a more intentional and effective manner. By using well-structured prompts, you can influence the tone, depth, format, and accuracy of the AI's response. These techniques help you get better, clearer, and more useful results by reducing ambiguity and setting clear expectations for the model. Understanding different types of prompt techniques—such as providing context, asking step-by-step questions, giving examples, or defining roles—enables you to communicate your intent more precisely. As a result, the AI can generate responses that are more relevant, reliable, and aligned with your goals, making interactions more productive and efficient.

Exercise 1: Identify the Prompt Technique

Objective:

Check understanding of different prompt techniques.

Task:

Determine which prompt technique is being used.

Instruction:

Read the prompt below and identify the technique applied.

Prompt:

“Summarize the following paragraph in one sentence.”

Answer: Zero-Shot Prompting

Expected Output:

Correct identification of the technique (Zero-Shot Prompting).

Exercise 2: Prompt Recognition

Objective:

Understand how a single example guides AI output.

Task:

Identify the prompt technique used.

Instruction:

Analyze the prompt below and name the technique.

Prompt:

“Example:

Question: What is AI?

Answer: AI refers to machines that can perform tasks requiring human intelligence.

Now answer: What is Prompt Engineering?”

Answer: One-Shot Prompting

Expected Output:

Correct identification of One-Shot Prompting.

Exercise 3 : Choose the Correct Technique

Objective:

Apply the correct prompting method based on scenario.

Task:

Select the most suitable prompt technique.

Instruction:

Read the scenario and choose the correct technique.

Scenario:

You want AI to follow the same writing style every time while generating responses.

Answer: Few-Shot Prompting. Explanation: Providing multiple examples allows the AI to learn and replicate a specific pattern or style consistently.

Expected Output:

Correct technique selection with a short justification (Few-Shot Prompting).

Exercise 4 : One-Shot Prompt Creation

Objective:

Practice writing a one-shot prompt.

Task:

Create a prompt using exactly one example.

Instruction:

Write a one-shot prompt to generate a polite response for a customer complaint, using one example response to guide tone.

Prompt:

Example:

Customer: "My order arrived broken and I'm very unhappy."

Response: "I am truly sorry to hear that your order arrived damaged. Please accept our apologies, and I will initiate a replacement for you immediately."

Expected Output:

A correctly structured one-shot prompt containing one example and a new task

Exercise 5 : Rewrite Using Correct Technique

Objective:

Apply prompt techniques in practice.

Task:

Rewrite the prompt using an appropriate technique.

Exercise 6 : True or False (Concept Trap)

Objective:

Check conceptual clarity.

Task:

Evaluate the statement.

Instruction:

Mark the statement as True or False and justify your answer.

Statement:

“Few-shot prompting is used when the task is very simple and well-known.”

Answer: False. Justification: Few-shot prompting is used for complex tasks or to establish a specific pattern; simple, well-known tasks typically only require Zero-Shot prompting.

Expected Output:

False, with correct explanation.

Instruction:

Improve the prompt below by choosing the correct technique (Zero-Shot, One-Shot, or Few-Shot).

Prompt:

“Make this sound professional: ‘Send this now.’”

Revised Prompt:

Example: 'Get back to me' -> 'Could you please provide an update when you have a moment?'

Task: 'Send this now.' -> 'Could you please send this at your earliest convenience?'

Expected Output:

A rewritten prompt using an example-based approach.

Exercise 7 : Prompt Comparison

Objective:

Understand how clarity affects AI responses.

Task:

Evaluate two prompts.

Instruction:

Compare the prompts below and identify which one will give better output.

Prompt A:

“Write a product description.”

Prompt B:

“Write a 3-sentence product description for a budgeting app targeting young professionals.”

Evaluation: Prompt B is better. Explanation: Prompt B provides specific constraints (length, topic, target audience), which helps the AI generate a more focused and relevant response.

Expected Output:

Selection of Prompt B with a short explanation.

Exercise 8 : Technique Selection (Tricky)

Objective:

Test understanding of when to use each technique.

Task:

Select the correct prompt technique.

Instruction:

Scenario: You want AI to consistently follow the same writing style across multiple outputs.

Choose the best technique and explain why.

Answer: Few-Shot Prompting. Reasoning: By providing multiple examples of the desired style, the model can identify and replicate the underlying pattern across different outputs.

Expected Output:

Correct technique selection (Few-Shot Prompting) with brief reasoning.

Exercise 9 : Bonus Challenge

Objective : You are unsure which technique to use.

Rule-based Question:

Fill in the blanks:

- Simple task, no examples → Zero-Shot prompting
- One example to guide style → One-Shot prompting
- Multiple examples to train pattern → Few-Shot prompting